

Xiaotian Liu

✉ xiaotian.liu@uq.edu.au ☎ +61 455 957 114
🆔 0000-0001-7580-5012 🎓 Google Scholar 🔗 LinkedIn

Research Profile

I am a marketing scholar specialising in digital marketing, marketing technology, and AI-mediated consumer and service interactions. My research is developing into a programme on how AI cues, platform design, recommendation interfaces, online auctions, AI disclosure, immersive commerce, and AI-related marketplace claims shape consumer judgement and market outcomes in social-impact contexts, including sustainable and prosocial behaviour. My published and accepted work provides a foundation in digital auctions, AI disclosure in charitable giving, and immersive commerce, while my current pipeline includes a dissertation paper preparing for submission to *International Journal of Research in Marketing*, manuscripts under review at *Journal of Service Research* and *Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science*, one manuscript at revise and resubmit (2nd round) and another at minor revision (3rd round) at *European Journal of Marketing*, and other manuscripts under review at ABDC A outlets. I use behavioural experiments, online and field studies, platform data, secondary data analysis, predictive modelling, and AI-assisted research workflows.

My teaching spans digital marketing, market and consumer research, business analytics, business research strategy, and analytics strategy across undergraduate and postgraduate levels. I connect research-informed marketing education with applied digital skills, analytics decision frameworks, experimentation, AI/data monetisation, AI-enabled smart-service design, inclusive learning design, and industry-engaged assessment. Through publications, ABDC A/A* manuscripts, student research supervision, grant activity, and industry collaboration, I am developing a research and teaching profile aligned with digital marketing, digital transformation, consumer insight, and impact-oriented marketing scholarship.

Education

PhD Candidate (Marketing) 2022 – Present
The University of Queensland *Brisbane, Australia*
Written examiner reports received; oral examination scheduled for late August 2026; degree completion anticipated in 2026.

Dissertation by publication: “Mitigating Embarrassment and Motivating Guilt: Consumer Emotion Management in the Age of AI”.

Marketing Models (PhD Level) 2022
The Ohio State University *Supervised by Professor Greg Allenby*

Bachelor of Business Management (Honours) 2021
The University of Queensland *Brisbane, Australia*
First Class Honours; GPA: 7.0/7.0; Dean’s Commendation for Academic Excellence.

Bachelor of Business (Marketing) 2019
La Trobe University *Melbourne, Australia*
WAM: 87/100; Provost Commendation Award.

PhD Dissertation Papers

1. **Liu, X.**, Pontes, N., & Popkowski Leszczyc, P. T. L. “Can Robots Replace Human Fundraisers? The Role of Moral Self-Awareness in Charitable Giving.”

under review (1st round) at *Journal of Service Research* [ABS 4; ABDC A*].

2. **Liu, X.**, Pontes, N., & Popkowski Leszczyc, P. T. L. “When Less Is Not More: Why Polite Communication Outperforms Minimal Interaction in Embarrassing Service Encounters.” Preparing for submission; target: *International Journal of Research in Marketing* [ABS 4; ABDC A*].

Peer-Reviewed Journal Publications

3. **Liu, X.**, Song, X., & Nguyen, M. (2027). “When AI disclosure makes charities seem less communal: The downside of disclosing AI-generated suggested donation amounts.” *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services*, 94, 104968. doi:10.1016/j.jretconser.2026.104968 [ABDC A].
4. **Liu, X.**, & Popkowski Leszczyc, P. T. L. (2023). “The reference price effect of historical price lists in online auctions.” *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services*, 103183. doi:10.1016/j.jretconser.2022.103183 [ABDC A].
5. Li, J., Haratbar, H. R., & **Liu, X.** (2026). “From image to expression: how social image drives plant-based meat purchase intention.” *Food Quality and Preference*, 143, 105943. doi:10.1016/j.foodqual.2026.105943 [ABDC A].
6. Wu, M., Shou, Z., Su, S. J., & **Liu, X.** (2025). “‘I’ Value the Future, but ‘We’ Value the Past: The Impact of Self-Construal on Nostalgia Versus Forestalgia Narrative Ads.” *Psychology & Marketing*, 42: 727–740. doi:10.1002/mar.22148 [ABS 3; ABDC A].
7. Wu, J., Zhang, D., Liu, T., **Liu, X.**, & Zhao, S. (2024). “Acceptance of Human Trust in Artificial Intelligence and Its Neurocognitive Mechanisms: An Empirical Study and Meta-Analysis of Neuroscience Experiments.” *Journal of Industrial Engineering and Engineering Management*, 38(1): 60–73. doi:10.13587/j.cnki.jieem.2024.01.005 [Chinese; SJR Q2; A-level management science journal recognised by the National Natural Science Foundation of China].

Book Chapters

8. **Liu, X.**, & Sun, D. “Chapter 11: The Future of Immersive Commerce.” Accepted for publication in M. Nguyen & Y. Zhang (Eds.), *Beyond the Screen: How Immersive Technologies Reshape Marketing*. Emerald Publishing.
9. **Liu, X.**, & Goyeneche, D. “Chapter 2: Data Foundations of AI Marketing.” Submitted for consideration in M. Nguyen & Y. Zhang (Eds.), *AI in Marketing: From Augmented Intelligence to Autonomous Markets*. Springer Nature.
10. Goyeneche, D., & **Liu, X.** “Chapter 4. Human-Robot Interaction and Collaboration.” Submitted for consideration in F. Seyitoğlu, S. Ivanov, & C. Webster (Eds.), *A Research Agenda for Service and Social Robots*. Edward Elgar Publishing.

Revise and Resubmit / Manuscripts Under Review

11. **Liu, X.**, Goyeneche, D., Haratbar, H. R., Pontes, N., & Popkowski Leszczyc, P. T. L. “AI-trained service providers? NO! The mediating role of perceived tacit knowledge.” **under review (1st round)** at *Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science* [ABS 4*; ABDC A*]; corresponding author.
12. **Liu, X.**, Meng, L., Han, J., & Popkowski Leszczyc, P. T. L. “Temporal Overlap, Valuation Uncertainty, and Price Formation in Digital Auctions.”

- revise and resubmit (2nd round)** at *European Journal of Marketing* [ABS 3; ABDC A*].
13. Zhang, R., Li, J., **Liu, X.**, Song, X., & Jiao, Z. “From AI Waste to Responsible Consumption: How AI Sustainability Disclosure Shapes Consumers’ Willingness to Buy.”
revise and resubmit (2nd round) at *Asia Pacific Journal of Marketing and Logistics* [ABDC A]; corresponding author.
 14. **Liu, X.**, Haratbar, H. R., & Zhou, X. “Enterprise GenAI Deployment and Downstream Accountability: The Role of Environmental Externalities in Consumer Responses.”
minor revision (3rd round) at *Journal of Enterprise Information Management* [ABDC A].
 15. **Liu, X.**, Haratbar, H. R., Nguyen, M., & Nham, T. P. “Name-Based Direct Address in AI-Driven Sustainable Recommendations: Self-Accountability and Recommendation Modality.”
under review (1st round) at *Journal of Strategic Marketing* [ABDC A].
 16. Chen, D.*, **Liu, X.***, Nguyen, M.*, Song, X.*, & Yu, X.*. “From Solo to Collective: How Group Visual Cues Activate Anticipated Effervescence in Volunteer Recruitment.” (*Authors listed alphabetically; all authors contributed equally)
minor revision (3rd round) at *European Journal of Marketing* [ABS 3; ABDC A*].
 17. He, Y., Popkowski Leszczyc, P. T. L., & **Liu, X.** “Value Revelation Through Absence: How Dispossession Reshapes Consumer Valuation and Market Response.”
under review (1st round) at *Marketing Theory* [ABS 3; ABDC A].
 18. Nguyen, M., Cao, T. T., **Liu, X.**, Song, X., & Liu, M. T. “Governing AI Supervision: Trust, Employment Security, and Employee Adaptation in AI-Enabled Work Transformation.”
under review (1st round) at *Technological Forecasting & Social Change* [ABS 3; ABDC A].
 19. Haratbar, H. R.*, **Liu, X.***, & Chaudhury, S. “Natural Inference and Its Limits: The Moderating Role of Product Anthropomorphism.” (*Co-first authors)
under review (1st round) at *Food Quality and Preference* [ABDC A].
 20. Wu, J., & **Liu, X.** “Practice what you recommend: Standard–conduct inconsistency and plant-based food adoption intentions.”
under review (1st round) at *Business Strategy and the Environment* [ABS 3; ABDC A]; corresponding author.
 21. **Liu, X.** “Do Synthetic Consumers Browse? Journey Compression in Generative-AI Representations of the Online Shopping Journey.”
under review (1st round) at *Journal of Internet Commerce* [CiteScore Best Quartile Q1].
 22. Nguyen, M., Cao, T. T., Nham, T., **Liu, X.**, & Zhang, Y. “Employee Voice Under AI Supervision: The Roles of Justice, Credibility, and Workplace Inclusion.”
under review (1st round) at *Employee Relations* [ABDC A].

Selected Working Papers

23. **Liu, X.**, Popkowski Leszczyc, P. T. L., & Allenby, G. M. “Bidding Under Exposure Risk: How Auction Format Shapes Bidding Strategies in Multi-Item Auctions.”
Target journal: *Marketing Science* [ABS 4*; ABDC A*].

24. **Liu, X.**, Gonzalez Arcos, C. F., Popkowski Leszczyc, P. T. L., & Haruvy, E. “Beyond Green Tourism: How Consumers Trade Off Sustainable Destination Attributes Across China and Australia.” Target journal: *Journal of Marketing Research* [ABS 4*; ABDC A*].
25. **Liu, X.** “Matching Claims to Evidence in Generative AI-Supported Higher Education: Perceived Support, Model-Inferred Interaction Cues, and Assessment Conditions.” Target journal: *Studies in Higher Education* [ABS 3; ABDC A].
26. Chen, D.*, & **Liu, X.*.** “Consumer Vulnerability at the Income-Feasibility Boundary: Evidence from U.S. Rent Burden and Chinese Well-Being.” (*Equal contribution) Target journal: *Journal of Public Policy & Marketing* [ABS 3; ABDC A].
27. Su, Y., Wu, J., **Liu, X.**, & Zhao, S. “Explainable AI in Human-AI Collaboration: A Systematic Review and Socio-Cognitive Coordination Framework.” Target journal: *Computers in Human Behavior* [ABDC A]; co-corresponding author.
28. **Liu, X.** “The interaction effect of user query type and ad appeal type on effectiveness of sponsored ads on AI platforms: A construal level perspective.” One experiment completed; target: *Journal of Advertising* [ABS 3; ABDC A].
29. Liu, G., **Liu, X.**, & Septianto, F. “Fabrication or Exaggeration: Consumers’ Attitudes Towards Different AI Washes.” One experiment completed; target: *Journal of Travel Research* [ABS 4; ABDC A*].
30. Liu, G., **Liu, X.**, & Meng, L. “Narrative Property Descriptions and Consumer Engagement: Evidence from Airbnb.”
31. **Liu, X.** “Technology Cues in Property Descriptions and Amenities: Effects on Booking Intentions on Airbnb.”

Conferences

1. **Liu, X.**, Gonzalez Arcos, C. F., Popkowski Leszczyc, P. T. L., & Haruvy, E. (2026). “Beyond Green Tourism.” Paper accepted for presentation at the Australian and New Zealand Marketing Academy (ANZMAC) Annual Conference.
2. **Liu, X.**, Goyeneche, D., Haratbar, H. R., Pontes, N., & Popkowski Leszczyc, P. T. L. (2026). “AI-trained service providers? NO! The mediating role of perceived tacit knowledge.” Competitive paper accepted for presentation at the Association for Consumer Research Annual Conference, Chicago, IL, USA.
3. **Liu, X.**, Pontes, N., & Popkowski Leszczyc, P. T. L. (2025). “When Less Is Not More: Why Polite Communication Outperforms Minimal Interaction in Embarrassing Service Encounters.” Poster presented at the Association for Consumer Research Annual Conference, Washington, DC.
4. **Liu, X.**, Pontes, N., & Popkowski Leszczyc, P. T. L. (2025). “When Less Is Not More: Why Polite Communication Outperforms Minimal Interaction in Embarrassing Service Encounters.” Paper presented at ANZMAC Annual Conference, Sydney, Australia.
5. **Liu, X.**, Chen, D., Song, X., & Yu, X. (2025). “From Solo to Collective: How Group Visual Cues Activate Anticipated Effervescence in Volunteer Recruitment.” Paper presented at ANZMAC Doctoral Colloquium, Sydney, Australia.
6. **Liu, X.**, Pontes, N., & Popkowski Leszczyc, P. T. L. (2024). “The Impact of Human vs. Robot Fundraisers on Donation Likelihood.” Paper presented at ANZMAC Doctoral Colloquium, Hobart, Australia.

7. Wu, M., Shou, Z., Su, S. J., & **Liu, X.** (2024). “‘I’ Value the Future, but ‘We’ Value the Past: The Impact of Self-Construal on Nostalgia Versus Forestalgia Narrative Ads.” Paper presented at ANZMAC Annual Conference, Hobart, Australia.
8. **Liu, X.**, Pontes, N., & Popkowski Leszczyc, P. T. L. (2023). “The influence of service providers’ politeness versus directness in embarrassing service encounters.” Paper presented at ANZMAC Doctoral Colloquium, Otago, New Zealand.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Associate

2025 – Present

University of Queensland Business School

Brisbane, Australia

Independently delivered undergraduate and postgraduate tutorial teaching in digital marketing, market and consumer research, and business analytics, with assessment feedback, student consultation, and curriculum support. In S2 2026, this profile extends into current teaching in business research strategy and a Co-Lecturer role in business analytics strategy, including workshop leadership, project consultation, analytics decision frameworks, experimentation, AI/data monetisation, and AI-enabled smart-service design.

- **MKTG3506 Digital Marketing and Social Media** (undergraduate): delivered tutorials for approximately 60 students across two groups. Covered digital marketing strategy, social media marketing, influencer marketing, content strategy, SEO audit, digital customer experience, and campaign development. S1 2026 overall tutor rating: 4.62/5.
- **MKTG7510 Market and Consumer Research** (postgraduate): delivered tutorials across two groups in S1 2025 and five groups in S1 2026. Supported students in designing market and consumer research, developing attitudinal measures, conducting segmentation, using SPSS and Qualtrics, and translating data into applied insight.
Supported assessment redesign for the 2026 MKTG7510 offering around an industry partnered applied research project, incorporating accessibility, inclusive design principles, and local and Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander cultural contexts.
 S1 2026 overall tutor rating: 4.78/5.
- **BSAN2204 Methods of Business Analytics** (undergraduate): delivered tutorials for approximately 120 students across four groups in S1 2026. Developed student capability in R programming, data manipulation and exploration, predictive modelling, and code optimisation. S1 2026 overall tutor rating: 4.38/5.
- **RBUS3900 Business Research Strategy** (undergraduate; S2 2026): currently teaching business research strategy, research design, and evidence-based decision making.
- **BSAN4201 Business Analytics Strategy** (undergraduate; S2 2026; Co-Lecturer): currently co-teaching a 64-student course, leading the 3-hour workshop component across 5–6 teaching weeks, serving as the first point of contact for student project queries and consultations, and contributing to assessment preparation and marking. Course content spans analytics decision frameworks (data-to-decisions, experimentation, and AI/data monetisation) and project-based design and commercialisation of AI-enabled smart services using GenAI-enhanced design thinking, synthetic-data conjoint analysis, the 5Vs framework, and organisational change planning.

Online Tutor

2020

Private Tutoring Agency for La Trobe University Students

Melbourne, Australia

- Supported online teaching in BUS3DIG Digital Business and ECO3CCE Climate Change Economics and Policy during the COVID-19 transition.

Teaching Assistant

2019

Shanghai International Studies University

Shanghai, China

- Supported Introduction to Management and International Marketing, co-taught with Senior Lecturer Nguyen (Beo) Thai, University of Wollongong.
- Developed supplementary teaching materials, managed grading, and facilitated office-hour support in an international academic environment.

Selected Teaching Development

HEA@UQ Program — Associate Fellowship (AFHEA)

2026 – Present

application in preparation

The University of Queensland

Brisbane, Australia

Enrolled in UQ's professional recognition program and developing an application aligned with PSF 2023 Descriptor 1.

Selected Research Training

Methodological background: Behavioural experiments, online and field studies, policy-relevant empirical modelling, choice and Bayesian modelling, and biometric measurement.

1. **HIT Big Data and Business Analytics Summer School** 2026
12th international summer school, Harbin Institute of Technology, Harbin, China.
2. **NTU–Sheth A-PRIME Consortium** 2026
Invitation-only Asia-Pacific Research Initiative for Marketing Early-Career Scholars, Nanyang Business School, Singapore; school nomination.
3. **AI for Business Summer School** 2025
University of Science and Technology of China.
4. **Experimental Design for Behavioural Sciences** 2023
HDR skills development course, The University of Queensland.
5. **Advanced Studies in Marketing** 2021
Choice modelling and discrete choice experiments, The University of Queensland.

Digital and Research Software

Analysis and modelling: R, Python, SPSS, and SAS.

Survey research: Qualtrics.

Languages: Mandarin Chinese and Shanghainese/Wu Chinese (native); English (professional proficiency).

Selected AI tools:

LitRelevanceAI; **PaperFeed** Literature screening; RSS monitoring and filtering.

GPT-as-Participants LLM-based experimental prototyping.

Student Research Supervision

Undergraduate Research Co-Supervision — Ren Zhang

2024 – Present

Co-supervised Ren Zhang with Associate Professor Li Jianmin on an AI sustainability disclosure project, advising on research design, data collection, analysis, and manuscript development. Outcome: manuscript **revise and resubmit (2nd round)** at *Asia Pacific Journal of Marketing and Logistics* [ABDC A]; corresponding author.

Master of Philosophy (MPhil) Research Co-Supervision — Ying Su 2024 – Present
Co-supervise Ying Su with Associate Professor Jun Wu, contributing to systematic review design, conceptual development, and manuscript preparation in explainable human–AI collaboration. Outcome: manuscript; target journal: *Computers in Human Behavior* [ABDC A]; co-corresponding author.

Scholarships, Grants, and Awards

Major Scholarships and Fellowships

University of Queensland Research Training Stipend	Oct 2022 – 2026
Full Scholarship, AI for Business Summer School <i>University of Science and Technology of China</i>	Jul 2025
UQ Business School Honours Tuition Fee Reduction Scholarship	2021
Tuition Fee Reduction Scholarship, La Trobe University	2019

Research Grants and Funding Activity

National Natural Science Foundation of China Grant No. 72374088 <i>Awarded external grant. Role: core team member; contributed to theoretical and conceptual development.</i>	2024 – Present
National Foundation for Australia-China Relations 2026–27 Grant Round Application <i>Project: “Australia–China Regional Tourism Dialogue and Readiness Program.” Amount requested: AUD 400,000; lead applicant: Dr Mai Nguyen (Griffith University). Role: project initiator, partnership broker, and proposal contributor. Application status: passed first-round screening; under review.</i>	2026
Partners: Griffith University; University of Macau; Shenzhen University; Jiangsu University of Science and Technology; CSADI Overseas Alumni Association.	

Additional Travel, Career Development, and Bursary Funding

UQ BEL Career Enhancement Fund	2025	AUD 1,500
UQ Association of Postgraduate Students Postgrad Bursary	2025	AUD 500
UQ Association of Postgraduate Students Postgrad Bursary	2024	AUD 500
ANZMAC Doctoral Colloquium Travel Grant	2024	AUD 1,000
ANZMAC23 DC Rohan Venkatraman’s Layton Travel Grant	2023	AUD 500
UQ Marketing Discipline HDR Conference Travel Top-up Funding	2023	AUD 300

Academic Honours and Awards

Dean’s Commendation for Academic Excellence, The University of Queensland	2021
Provost’s Commendation, La Trobe University	2019, 2020

Industry Engagement

Industry-Partnered Research Collaboration

<i>NewLand Property Group Australia; Zhuozheng Holdings Group</i>	2026 – Present
Partnering to embed real client briefs in MKTG7510 assessment projects and develop applied insights with industry stakeholders.	<i>Australia and China</i>

Grant Application and Partnership Building

<i>Tourism Grant Partnership Building</i>	2026
Initiated and brokered an AUD 400,000 multi-institutional Australia–China tourism grant application led by Dr Mai Nguyen; passed first-round screening and remains under review.	<i>Australia, Mainland China, and Macau</i>

Strategic Advisor

2025 – Present

Sustainable Transportation Startup

North America

Providing strategic marketing and business plan consulting for an electric concrete truck startup, with a focus on market positioning and commercial scale-up.

Leadership, Service, and Collegiality

EQUIS Accreditation Student Lead

2023 – 2024

University of Queensland Business School

Brisbane, Australia

Authored UQ Business School's official EQUIS Student Report and coordinated student and faculty stakeholder input, contributing to a successful accreditation outcome.

Ad Hoc Reviewer

Journals: Journal of Experimental Psychology: Applied; Psychology & Marketing; Information Economics and Policy; Bulletin of Economic Research.

Conferences: ANZMAC Annual Conference, 2023, 2024, 2026.

Conference Volunteering

- Australian and New Zealand Marketing Academy (ANZMAC) Annual Conference, 2023; University of Otago, Dunedin, Otago, New Zealand.
- Australian and New Zealand Marketing Academy (ANZMAC) Annual Conference, 2024; University of Tasmania, Hobart, Tasmania, Australia.
- 26th Labour Econometrics Workshop (LEW), 2024; School of Economics, The University of Queensland, St Lucia, Brisbane, Queensland, Australia.

References

Professor Peter Popkowski Leszczyc

Professor of Marketing

The University of Queensland

✉ p.popkowski@business.uq.edu.au

Associate Professor Nicolas Pontes

Associate Professor of Marketing

The University of Queensland

✉ n.pontes@uq.edu.au

Dr David Goyeneche

Lecturer in Marketing

The University of Western Australia

✉ david.goyeneche@uwa.edu.au

Dr Thomas Magor

Lecturer in Marketing (Teaching Focused)

The University of Queensland

✉ t.magor@business.uq.edu.au